

 Echo

Data Intelligence Assistant

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Echo — Data Intelligence Assistant

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quarter_01_sales.csv 3.4MB

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Dataset Preview

	Date	Store Location	Product Category	Product Name	Quantity Sold	Unit Price (₦)	Total Sales (₦)	Payment Method	Salesperson
0	01/01/2025	Gwarinpa	Uncategorised	Unknown Product	12	1244.11	14929.32	None	Dami
1	01/01/2025	Wuse	Household Items	Detergent	1000	486.88	486880	Transfer	Alice
2	01/01/2025	Gwarinpa	Uncategorised	Unknown Product	-1	-377.7	-500	Cash	Fatima
3	01/01/2025	Wuse	Uncategorised	Unknown Product	0	1761.54	100000	Cash	Unknown
4	01/01/2025	Wuse	Beverages	Pepsi	17	439.16	7465.72	POS	Cynthia
5	01/01/2025	Utako	Uncategorised	Unknown Product	11	1866.07	20526.77	POS	Chinedu
6	01/01/2025	Gwarinpa	Beverages	Fanta	1000	1894.04	1894040	POS	Alice
7	01/01/2025	Central Area	Snacks	Cake	19	-408.79	100000	Cash	Alice
8	01/01/2025	Gwarinpa	Household Items	Toilet Roll	0	-155.7	0	Transfer	Bola
9	01/01/2025	Wuse	Beverages	Coca-Cola	1000	265.66	265660	Transfer	Bola

Data Profile

Rows	Columns	Missing Values	Numeric Columns
49,549	9	12373	3

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 Automatic EDA Charts



Executive Summary

✦ Generate Executive Summary

Executive Summary: Sales Data Review

This executive summary provides an overview of the provided sales dataset, highlighting key operational patterns, critical data quality issues, opportunities for improvement, and actionable recommendations.

Key Patterns & Trends

- **High Sales Activity:** The dataset covers 90 days, with a significant peak on '15/01/2025' (619 transactions). The average total sales per transaction is approximately #219,928.
- **Dominant Store Locations:** 'Central Area', 'Gwarinpa', and 'Wuse' are the top three store locations by transaction volume, collectively accounting for over 60% of recorded sales activities.
- **Product Categories & Names:** After the pervasive "Uncategorised" and "Unknown Product" entries, "Snacks" and "Beverages" emerge as the most frequent product categories. Popular specific products include Chin Chin, Meat Pie, Pepsi, and Fanta.
- **Payment Preferences:** POS is the most frequently recorded payment method (12,569 transactions), closely followed by Transfer and Cash.
- **Salesperson Performance:** Alice is the most active salesperson, indicating potential for benchmarking best practices.

Data Quality & Risks

- **Critical Data Inconsistencies & Errors:**
 - **Negative Values:** Presence of negative `Quantity Sold` (min -1), `Unit Price (₦)` (min -499.87), and `Total Sales (₦)` (min -500.00) indicates significant data entry errors or uncaptured business logic (e.g., returns processed as negative sales without clear distinction). **This is the most severe data quality issue, undermining the reliability of all sales metrics.**
 - **Sales Calculation Discrepancy:** The sample data clearly shows `Total Sales (₦)` is not consistently `Quantity Sold * Unit Price (₦)`. For instance, a quantity of 0 with a high total sales value, or a negative unit price leading to a large positive total sales. This fundamentally breaks the integrity of sales data.
- **Missing Critical Data:**
 - `Payment Method` : A substantial 12,372 missing values (approximately 25% of the dataset) for `Payment Method` severely limits the ability to analyze payment trends, reconciliation, and customer preferences.
 - `Quantity Sold` : One missing value for `Quantity Sold` is minor but should be addressed.
- **Poor Data Categorization:**
 - `Uncategorised` / `Unknown Product` : A staggering 19,868 entries (over 40% of the dataset) fall under "Uncategorised" product category and "Unknown Product" name. This renders granular product performance analysis nearly impossible and suggests a fundamental

flaw in product catalog management or transaction logging.

- **Inconsistent Salesperson Entry:** The presence of 'Unknown' as a salesperson reduces accountability and performance tracking.
- **Incorrect Data Type:** The `Date` column is stored as an `object` (string), which prevents direct temporal analysis without conversion.

Opportunities & Insights

- **Improved Operational Efficiency:** Resolving the negative values and sales calculation discrepancies offers an immediate opportunity to enhance data accuracy, improve reporting reliability, and identify potential process gaps in handling returns or corrections.
- **Enhanced Product Strategy:** Categorizing the "Uncategorised" and "Unknown Product" entries will unlock rich insights into actual product performance, inventory management needs, and opportunities for targeted marketing and promotions.
- **Deeper Payment Analysis:** Addressing missing `Payment Method` data would enable a clearer understanding of customer payment preferences, aiding in optimizing payment infrastructure and reducing transaction costs.
- **Sales Performance Optimization:** With cleaner data, detailed analysis of store, salesperson, and product performance can drive strategic decisions regarding resource allocation, sales targets, and incentive programs.
- **Temporal Trend Analysis:** Converting the `Date` column will allow for robust time-series analysis to identify seasonal trends, peak sales periods, and long-term growth or decline.

Recommendations

1. Immediate Data Cleaning & Validation:

- **Prioritize Resolution of Negative Values and Calculation Errors:** Investigate the root cause of negative `Quantity Sold`, `Unit Price (₹)`, and `Total Sales (₹)`. Define clear rules for handling returns, refunds, or corrections, ensuring these are recorded accurately (e.g., as separate transaction types or with appropriate positive values).
- **Correct Sales Calculation:** Implement a validation rule to ensure `Total Sales (₹)` is consistently and accurately calculated as `Quantity Sold * Unit Price (₹)`. Address all existing discrepancies.
- **Convert Date Column:** Convert the `Date` column to a proper datetime format for time-based analysis.

2. Product Data Enrichment:

- **Mandate Product Categorization:** Develop and enforce a comprehensive product categorization system. Implement processes to minimize or eliminate 'Uncategorised' and 'Unknown Product' entries moving forward.
- **Retroactive Categorization:** Initiate a project to retroactively categorize the existing 'Uncategorised' and 'Unknown Product' entries, even if it requires manual review and mapping. This is essential for unlocking the value of historical data.

3. Address Missing Values & Operational Gaps:

- **Investigate Payment Method Missingness:** Determine the reason for missing `Payment Method` data. Implement system changes or training to ensure this crucial field is always captured. Consider a strategy for imputing or marking historical missing values if their origin cannot be determined.
- **Standardize Salesperson Entry:** Implement strict data entry for `Salesperson` to eliminate 'Unknown' entries, ensuring all sales can be attributed.

4. Implement Data Governance & Quality Checks:

- Establish ongoing data validation rules and automated checks at the point of data entry or ingestion to prevent future occurrences of negative values, missing data, and incorrect calculations.
- Provide training to data entry personnel on data quality standards and the importance of accurate record-keeping.

By addressing these critical data quality issues, the organization can transform this dataset into a reliable asset for informed decision-making, leading to improved operational efficiency and enhanced business strategies.

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